

Management

- Garbage chutes are not to be used for the disposal of recyclable materials. Signage to this effect should be displayed near service openings.
- Arrangements must be in place for the regular maintenance and cleaning of garbage chutes and any associated service rooms, service openings and charging devices.
- Arrangements must be in place for the regular transferal of recyclable materials (which are stored in service rooms) to the main waste/recycling storage room.

Service Lifts

- A service lift (or service elevator) may be appropriate in place of a waste chute in developments where a caretaker is to be employed.
- A service lift is a dedicated elevator system for the transport of waste and recycling containers and other equipment required for the operation of the development.
- A waste service compartment must be provided on each floor of the development to allow residents to store waste and recyclables.
- Residents place their waste and recyclables in bins provided and these are transported daily by the caretaker to the waste storage room.
- Each service room must be designed with sufficient space for the storage of two days waste and recycling for all residents on that level.
- Applicants will need to check with Council whether this option is acceptable.

Compactors

- Compactors are used to compress the waste (or recyclables) into smaller collection containers.
- The compaction ratio is typically set at around 2:1. Higher ratios are not used as they may result in heavier bins, causing OH&S problems, mechanical damage and breakage of recyclable materials.
- Best practice compaction systems compact directly into a 240 litre bin or a skip, reducing the requirement of manually loading the compacted waste into bins or skips.
- Compactors are extremely useful for mixed garbage, if used for recyclables extreme care must be taken not to cross contaminate the recycling streams.
- Compactors are less useful for steel containers and should not be used for glass.
- Compactors require regular maintenance. In particular, systems fed from a chute can be prone to blockages or failure of the “electronic eye”, which can result in garbage overflowing or backing up the chute. As a result if the 2:1 compaction ratio, the requirement for garbage storage bins is halved. This information was sourced from: Resource NSW (The Department of the Environment and Conservation), “Better Practice Guide for Waste Management in Multi-Unit Dwellings”, 2002.

Source: *Better Practice Guide for Waste Management in Multi-Unit Dwellings*, DECC, 2008.